AWS releases Strands Harness

AWS has released Strands Harness, an open source agent framework designed to provide the components needed to build and run general-purpose AI agents without creating the orchestration layer from scratch. Licensed under Apache 2.0, the framework can be deployed locally or in cloud environments and can be used with a range of AI models. AWS says it can be set up with a single line of Python or TypeScript.

The harness supports models from Amazon Bedrock, Anthropic, OpenAI and Google, along with local models through Ollama and LiteLLM. Developers can install it using Python or npm, and deploy it in environments capable of running Linux containers, including services such as Amazon ECS, Google Cloud Run and Cloudflare Containers.

A major focus is reducing the amount of context consumed during agent operation. Strands Harness truncates tool results exceeding about 1500 tokens, begins context compaction when the context window reaches 85 percent capacity and performs context recovery when an overflow occurs. Prompt caching is also enabled by default.

The framework is also intended to make agent development easier to move from experimentation to deployment. The underlying Strands ecosystem provides support for tools, model portability, memory, sessions, multi-agent patterns, streaming, guardrails and evaluation.



2200 particle accelerator control computers and embedded systems from Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) to Debian 13 ('Trixie') by the end of this year.

The primary trigger was Red Hat's progressive tightening of compiler microarchitecture baselines. CERN's accelerator infrastructure manages more than 2200 specialised front-end computers and 17,000 embedded devices. When Red Hat builds RHEL, it picks a minimum central processing unit (CPU) generation the software will run on. RHEL 9's upstream microarchitecture mandates already obsolete CERN's oldest boards, the kind running chips like Intel's legacy Core 2 Duo and Ivy Bridge, which comprise about 47 percent of their fleet. Staying on RHEL would force CERN to replace functional legacy hardware and redesign custom circuit boards at an estimated cost of US$ 6.58 million.

CERN selected Debian because it supports older 64-bit hardware, offers a massive software library and works well with industrial tools. Also, built-in real-time updates in the Linux kernel allow Debian to run time-sensitive systems without needing specialised software.

Both CERN engineers emphasised that the migration is strictly scoped to accelerator control hardware.

Dutch ditch Windows for NixOS

The Dutch government has officially thrown its weight behind a fully open source, sovereign digital workspace designed for public administration, anchored by a custom NixOS-based desktop environment.

Known as DAWO (Digitaal Autonome Werkomgeving Overheid or Digital Autonomous Government Work Environment), the initiative is not a monolithic application but a modular ecosystem. It integrates interchangeable tools spanning operating systems, cloud networks, AI utilities, messaging services and office collaboration suites.



Commissioned by the Ministry of the Interior and Kingdom Relations (BZK), the MijnBureau is a core self-hosted suite that integrates open source platforms like Nextcloud, Collabora, Element and OpenProject. Development is closely coordinated with similar sovereign tech pushes across Europe, including France's La Suite and Germany's openDesk. Project repositories are hosted on the internal Forgejo platform and mirrored on Codeberg to invite public contributions.

Developers evaluated several Linux distributions, including openSUSE and Fedora, before choosing NixOS as the ideal base for their client operating system. Beyond the intrinsic appeal of its Dutch roots, NixOS presents distinct administrative advantages. Free from commercial vendor lock-in, its declarative configuration model and strictly reproducible builds simplify security auditing, maintenance and system deployment across thousands of civil service machines.

Anthropic debuts AI-powered security tool for open source code

Anthropic has launched OSS Scanner, a free, opt-in service that uses its strongest language models, including Claude Mythos, to scan open source projects for security vulnerabilities automatically. This initiative aims to help maintainers patch weaknesses before attackers can exploit them.